Susanne Hansen

Senior Executive Assistant

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SUMMARY

Senior executive assistant who builds and runs the systems an executive office depends on: the business rhythm, executive project management, and calendars managed to strategic objectives instead of incoming requests. Seven years supporting multiple senior leaders in large multi-site organizations, most recently two executive directors whose competing calendars she ran as one plan. Led the SOP work that put a new campus on one playbook, led an executive assistant team, and ran the support behind a leadership team's meeting rhythm, from agendas and briefings to decisions tracked to completion. This year built her own working system from scratch: one decision list, one shared knowledge base, and a team of AI agents with defined jobs and a person's sign-off. Does her best work when trusted to own the office. Discreet, writes in a principal's voice, and works in Google Workspace and Slack.

EXPERIENCE

AI Operator · Independent Project January 2026 – Present

A self-directed year of putting AI to work, including on a real health-tech use case.

- Brings AI into everyday knowledge work, including scheduling, the inbox, and meeting prep, and checks every result before it goes out.
- Designs and operates a team of AI agents across Claude, ChatGPT, and Grok, each with a defined role and a written runbook; keeps learning newer tools, including Gemini.
- Created one decision list for everything awaiting review or approval: each item says what it is, where to find it, and exactly what's needed, so decisions don't stall or get lost.
- Built one shared knowledge base every AI agent works from; confidential information is kept out by rule.
- Knows which work to hand to AI and which has to stay with a person; the work stays visible and moves only with approval.

Senior Executive Assistant · The Village Church, Flower Mound, Texas January 2024 – December 2025

Hybrid. Strategic partner to the Executive Directors of Operations and of Engagement and Communications in a large multi-site organization. Worked across Communications and Marketing, and Technology and Operations.

- Owned two competing high-volume executive calendars as one integrated plan, prioritizing requests, resolving conflicts, and protecting prep time before high-visibility meetings.
- Managed an executive inbox with a global audience: filtered and flagged, drafted replies and correspondence for signature, and surfaced only what needed the executive.
- Planned executive retreats and supported the leadership team's meeting rhythm: handled logistics and prepared agendas, briefing materials, presentations, and talking points; turned notes into executive summaries and tracked decisions, action items, owners, and deadlines to completion.
- Coordinated vendor, architect, and construction meetings and supported Operations budget preparation for a multi-year, multi-campus buildout.
- Helped onboard new hires and kept priorities, commitments, and relationships steady through executive and administrative staff turnover.
- Proposed an AI readiness program, recruited the people who wanted in, and led the workshops; in Communications and Marketing, ran a one-on-one discovery session with each team member. Served on the three-person executive team for AI implementation and use policy.
- After a restructuring, stepped in as a de facto consultant and built role-specific workflows that helped Communications and Marketing through 45% departmental turnover in four months.

Executive Ghostwriter · Independent Contractor January 2022 – December 2024

Fully remote. Strategic partner to clients including health-tech founders and ed-tech leaders.

- Managed projects, timelines, and client expectations in close collaboration with each principal's product and technology teams.
- Shaped the narrative, then wrote the thought leadership, presentations, and book chapters published under each principal's name, in strict confidence.

Inflight Crew · American Airlines May 2018 – December 2022

A long-held goal, pursued between executive roles.

- Delivered calm, professional service on domestic and international routes on a schedule that changed constantly, including the days the operation broke down; learned from the inside where an itinerary fails and how to plan around it.
- Saw a communication gap between the crew on the line and the administration, and was selected to work with the administration on in-flight crew policy training and compliance.

Senior Executive Assistant · Bent Tree Church, Carrollton, Texas January 2013 – May 2018

A large Dallas-based church with campuses in two states. Gatekeeper and high-touch support for the Senior Pastor on a local and international speaking schedule; also supported the operational team and the board.

- Owned the calendar, speaking engagements, and all domestic and international travel, including remote regions, from booking through travel risk and security, and stayed on call while the Senior Pastor traveled.
- Sat on the strategic team for a multi-campus expansion and led the communications and SOP work to open a new campus: brought in staff from the other sites to train the new team on values and culture, routed all communication through the main office, and put every campus on one playbook.
- Served as the first point of contact for staff, guests, donors, and public-relations contacts, screening requests and declining what didn't belong on the calendar.
- Led the executive assistant team and provided back-up support when a teammate was out; also led other initiatives and projects from research through training and implementation.
- Prepared expense reports and budget analysis with the Director of Finance; drafted correspondence and first-pass presentations.
- Managed donor relations and events in support of a $22 million fundraiser; hosted visiting speakers and coordinated their green room with the event staff.

EARLIER CAREER

Operations Manager (3+ years, 3 direct reports) · Financial Analyst, Arthur Andersen / Accenture · Statistical Forecasting and Analysis, Mary Kay Cosmetics

TOOLS

Google Workspace (Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs, Sheets) · Zoom, Slack · Asana, Notion · Mac · AI: Claude, ChatGPT, Grok, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot · Microsoft Office (Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams), SharePoint, OneDrive

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration, Accounting · Southern Methodist University, Dallas, Texas

LANGUAGES

English and Danish

TRAVEL

Valid passport and active driver's license; happy to travel domestically and internationally.